

e CSM/PSE/AE/SAE run parallel and it is very important that all roles work together to help the customer be successful. Retention and expansion is typically the purview of the CSM regarding most project management and technical aspects of customer success, but it's important for the AE/SAE to conduct ongoing sales engagement activities with the account in order to provide dependable touch points for customer support. This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) will layout the steps, tasks, and deliverables necessary by all parties below related to account management.

- Strategic Account Executive (Enterprise) or Account Executive (SMB or Mid Market)
- Customer Success Manager
- Solutions Architect
- Professional Services

1.Customer Onboarding

Customer onboarding is a term typically used to describe the process users go through, from the start of their journey to become a customer and beyond. Within GitLab, customer onboarding encompasses an the SAE/AE conducting an official introduction and account management transition to CSM and PSE to customer stakeholders via a Welcome Call. Additionally, the CSM will begin to re-validate an understanding of the customer's use case, technology stack. The tasks that need to be accomplished are below:

1. Professional Services Implementation kick-off. CSM manages the kick-off and implementation plan catered to the customer.

- Professional Services helps your customer accelerate their DevOps Transformation by delivering services to improve operational efficiency, accelerate time to market and reduce risk through GitLab product adoption. We accomplish these by offering categories of services to help ensure the initial GitLab rollout goes smoothly so the end users can get value as fast as possible. It is important for a ISR/SAE to understand the services that certain types of customers typically engage in and how to position those services when building out a success plan. Utilize the Positioning Professional Services handbook page to understand all the services available to customers and how to market to them.

1. Solution Architect transitions customer meta-record and technical profile to PSE or CSM.

1. Account Executive transitions customer meta-record and business profile to CSM

1. Define transition process for customers. Plans should not end at signature but from their goal and work backwards

- SAE/AE updates Command Plan
- CSM builds the Success Plan

1. CSM creates and execute onboarding and implementation plans

1. Customer Implementation

2.Implementation

Implementation is focused on ensuring the customer has the right infrastructure to support GitLab solution operations. For self-managed customers, this could include setting up on-premises equipment and/or cloud infrastructure. For customers leveraging GitLab.com, this includes integration of the GitLab cloud service with the customers environment (e.g., SAML SSO integration). This is considered complete when production infrastructure is ready for use.

2.1 Success Planning

There are two types of success plans in Gainsight. The first is the ROI Success Plan described above. The second type is the Stage Adoption Success Plan. This success plan is an internal document allowing the CSM to track progress and goals on driving stage adoption within an account.

The Return on Investment (ROI) Success Plan is a customer facing interactive map created by a CSM to align the purchase (or renewal!) reasons to customer outcomes, develop joint accountabilities, measure progress and evolve as customers' needs change. Put another way, it's the way the customer can see and know that they're attaining significantly more value than the cost of a product or service. Success Planning focuses on helping customers achieve their desired objectives and recognizes that the purchase transaction is just the beginning of the customer's journey with GitLab. This includes outlining a vision to customers that combines the GitLab road map with the customer road map.

- CSM responsibilities include a full use-case, stakeholder, technology stack, and opportunity discovery with the account customer. The information gathered for the customer's success plan is housed in GainSight, which is embedded as an additional link within Salesforce.
- CSM coordinates and educates customer and positions them for GitLab Certification with GitLab 101.

2.2 Stage Adoption

The objective is to support our customer's utilization of the GitLab solution to address the customer's original purchase intent (i.e., product stage(s) and capabilities, licenses). Stage Adoption is complete when the following questions can be answered:

- Have 80% of the licenses from the original purchases are activated?
- Is the customer successfully adopting the capabilities or stages from their original purchase intent?
- Will these be measured according to product analytics (if available) or through agreement with the customer.

As part of our customer journey, we highly value the customer's initial experience and measure time-to-value. This is done according to Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) Specifically, we will measure the time in calendar days from the initial transaction to:

- Engagement: Represents our time to engage the customer. Completion defined when the CSM has their first meeting with the customer.
- Onboarding: Completion is defined when all the onboarding tasks are done.
- Infrastructure Ready: Completion is defined as either 1) production implementation is complete for on-premises installations 2) GitLab.com is integrated into a customer's environment or 3) Cloud and on-premises environments ready for a hybrid deployment
- First Value: Represents a small subset of users are using the product in a Production environment. This is achieved when a customer activates 10% of their licenses.
- Outcome Achieved: Represents delivery to original purchase intent. We want to capture the delivery of outcomes against their original purchase intent. New and changed goals will continue to be tracked with the engagement, but not included in this milestone.

3. Customer Account Management (Retention)

Customer service is an important aspect of the customer journey. The reason this is so important is that most of your revenue from an account will come from renewals and license growth. To do this, a consistent customer buying experience must be provided through exceptional customer service and account management activities. Within GitLab this is done by keeping track of how the account is progressing, understanding the issues and requests that are important to the account, navigating delivery of key milestones (onboarding, EBR, renewal), and escalating and responding to account risks quickly. Below are the main tasks that need to be conducted for effective Customer Account Management.

3.1 Ongoing Customer Engagement

It is important that both the SAE/AE and CSM conduct ongoing customer touchpoints and engagements. The following are tasks that fall under the purview of ongoing customer engagement:

- SAE/CSM continually re-verify and documents customer's positive business outcomes and connects the GitLab solution with their pain.
 - Success Plans for CSMs in GainSight
 - Command Plan for SAEs in Salesforce
- CSM develops a clear process for responding to problems that support escalations (collaborating with Sales, Support, Product, and Engineering, CSMs). Host escalation calls and manage the customer from an escalated state back to a normal state. SAE supports the CSM.
- SAE/AE/CSM continually meets with customers to capture problems, adjust the plan, reinforce confidence, and identify new opportunities to resell.
- SAE/AE remains present on how the customer is achieving their positive business outcomes.

3.2 Customer Account Maintenance Tasks

3.2.1 Daily Activities (SAE/AE)

Below are the activities that should be documented by the SAE/AE in real-time.

- Update Salesforce to capture next steps, dates in order to maintain a current status and log major events on the account.
- Update the Command Plan Opportunity Overview to ensure the account/opportunity assumptions are current and accurate.
- Update the MEDDPIC section of the Command Plan to ensure pertinent data is up-to-date and accurate
- Update the Close Plan and Close Date to ensure you're forecasting accurately

3.2.3 Weekly Account Maintenance Activities (SAE/AE)

Below are the WEEKLY TASK you'll need to perform within Clari.

- Clari-Forecast Values (Net New) - Document regional news, success stories, closed, won, and organizational issues
- Clari-Forecast Value (Renewal) - Document and discuss field marketing details with your patch.

For in-depth training on Clari go to the Clari for Salespeople Instructional Videos.

3.3 Conduct Executive Business Reviews (CSMs)

An Executive Business Review (EBR) is a strategic meeting with stakeholders from both GitLab and the customer. Together with the SAE/AE, a CSM is responsible for scheduling and conducting EBRs and working with their customers to achieve the primary objectives and desired business outcomes. The CSM will own the content creation, and together the SAE/AE and CSM will determine the flow of the review based on best practices and insight into the customer relationship.

CSMs should hold EBRs with each of their customers at least once per year. Larger ARR accounts or those with more strategic initiatives may benefit from or even require a quarterly cadence, a decision to be made by the CSM, SAE/AE, and Sales/CS leadership.

The CSM will coordinate with SALSA to determine who will invite the stakeholders to ensure we get the right people into the room, build the EBR deck, and tell a story around the presentation that is solution and value focused.

4. Customer Account Expansion

4.1 CSM Customer Account Expansion Activities

Below are some of the top processes to be performed by CSM Managers on a recurring cadence. The overall goal is to ensure the CSM Manager has a strong grasp on their team's group of customers through various data points (health, Support tickets, Onboarding objects, renewals, etc.). Resources such as Dashboards and videos are included for easy reference.

- Conduct regular Health Checks with customers.
- Conduct Renewal Review Meeting with SAE/AE. A key part of the customer relationship lifecycle is the renewal phase. CSMs must proactively track the renewal dates of their customers and align with their Strategic Account Manager (SAE) to ensure that a customer renewal takes place. At the beginning of each month a CSM should review their list of accounts in Salesforce and note the renewal dates for their accounts. If a renewal date is within six months the CSM should schedule two "Renewal Review" meetings with the appropriate SAE and Solutions Architect (SA). The first "Renewal Review" meeting should be scheduled five months out from the renewal date and the second should be scheduled three months out from the renewal date.
- Conduct SAE/SA/CSM meetings to review forecasting, pipeline, and identify new sales opportunities.
- Develop Net Promoter Score NPS/ CSAT twice per year to rate general customer satisfaction (after closed cases).

4.2 CSM Review Checklist

For CSM Managers, here is a short checklist to assist in the review:

- Account assignment: Accounts have been reviewed and are assigned or are in review
- Customer Onboarding: Customers in the Onboarding phase have been reviewed and onboarding status and notes are complete
- Success Plans: Customers have a Success Plan, it is being communicated with the customer, and the CSM is using it as the guiding document

- Triage and Health: Health for all CSM-assigned accounts have been updated within the last month, and any accounts in Triage are being evaluated
- Renewal Review: Upcoming customer renewals have been reviewed · the CSM has updated customer health and communicated with the SAE and SA for the upcoming renewal

4.3 SAE/AE Customer Account Expansion Activities

Once renewal opportunities are identified at the monthly renewal meeting, the SAE/AE should conduct in-depth engagements with the customer with a baseline from the account/product tier purchased at the original deal closure.

4.3.1 Discovery Call Meetings

Use the Command Plan within Salesforce to capture the following information for the renewal opportunity

- Engage regularly with the CTO to re-validate top priorities
- Review the 18-24 month plan and align the plan as necessary to the customer's priorities
- Capture the primary team/division's success with the product so far
- Capture from the organization what other toolchains they are using, what outcomes they seek, and metrics for success with their timelines
- Capture their budget projections for future expansion

4.3.2 Account Expansion Strategy

Meet with the CSM/SA to review the information captured from your discovery meeting and align it with the data the CSM has captured in the Success Plan. Use the data and questions below to determine a tailored expansion strategy.

- Does the GitLab product make an impact on the customer's vision? Does it solve their problem(s)?
- How does the product impact change over the long term?
- How does the product impact the budget allocation or will it be discretionary spending? How will this impact their decision to expand? Do we need to reduce friction on cost versus features?
- Does the original POV scale beyond the original group and solves problems for the larger organization? Do we need a new POV that aligns better with the customer's priorities?

These questions should be answered as a team with the SAE/AE, CSM, and SA pulling together data to make an informed decision about the account expansion strategy that aligns best with the customer's top long term priorities.

4.3.3. Customer Deck Renewal Deal Package

As you did in the Facilitate the Opportunity and Deal Closure, you will need an updated customer deck. This consists of an overall deal package to engage the economic buyer with a package that aligns high level business priorities with GitLabs Value Drivers. The focus of the renewal customer package is to make them more forward thinking by investing earlier and having a full toolbox as they grow.

The customer deck should be created with the idea that your champion can present it to the economic buyer. To do this you will need to work side-by-side with your advocates, champions, CSM, and SA to update the customer deck and provide the following components to an economic buyer:

1. Current state of GitLab usage
2. Case study that aligns with the customer's top priorities
3. Justification
 - Includes a market thesis on where the market is currently and what they'll gain over time by investing now versus waiting. If they buy at a higher tier they'll have specific features as needed but also gain single application capability when they need it.
4. Preliminary pricing proposal that aligns with the value GitLab is delivering while taking into consideration the customer's budget or financial constraints

SECTION: sales/sales-operating-procedures/engage-and-educate-the-customer/index.md

Your goal as a sales representative is to build 2.5 -3x your annual ARR quota. The ability to achieve this goal is based on your ability to create Moments That Matter (MTM), interactions with a customer that make a positive emotional impact about the value you and your product bring to their organization. The ability to Engage and Educate the Customer is fundamental to creating positive Moments That Matter.

In this Sales Standard Operating Procedures page, the four phases of the sales cycle are:

1. Engage & Educate
1. Facilitate the Opportunity
1. Deal Closure, and
1. Retention and Expansion

Step 1: Analyze your territory

In order to accomplish this you must understand your territory. Think of your territory as your book of business, patch, or market segment. Most often your territory or book of business will be a mix of net new and renewal accounts. Companies operate in many different business verticals. The steps to understanding your territory are questions you need to answer such as:

1. How much are they using GitLab?
1. How do they buy software? (Routes to Market)

How much GitLab are customers using?

Create a visual diagram of your territory similar to this example on slide 5.

1. Visually list each organization you currently do business with or want to do business with.
1. Breakdown each organization into departments, divisions, or branches. This breakdown depends on the business vertical.
1. Color code in green each of the departments, division, or branches that is currently utilizing GitLab

1. Color code yellow, the department, divisions, or branches that DevOps focused that are currently evaluating or testing GitLab.

1. Color code in red the departments, divisions or branches within each organization that perform DevOps but are currently not using GitLab

From this diagram you can determine what accounts need a point of entry developed. From the diagram, you will notice that within some organizations, there are departments/divisions who are early adopters and users of GitLab. Your goal is to leverage the early adopters success to leverage engagements with other low touch opportunities or net new opportunities.

Strategic goal

Your strategic goal is to incrementally turn the red and yellow divisions within an organization into green GitLab users. Eventually the entirety of the organization will be green GitLab users. The question here is how do you ripen the fruit faster for harvest? By understanding how your customers buy.

Step 2: Understand how your customers buy

Customers often buy software in multiple ways, but your ability to understand how they acquire technology will help you be more focused on the most common routes your customers use. The most common are direct purchase, through channel, and programs.

Determine your customers common routes to market and best strategies for territory engagement.

1. Create a list of your territory's three most common business verticals.

1. Discuss the most common routes to market for each business vertical.

Work with your extended team to analyze your territory and build your strategy. Your team may consist of a variety of the following:

- SDR
- ISR
- SA
- CSM
- Reseller Channel Mgr
- SI Channel Manager
- OEM/Cloud Channel Manager
- Field Marketing

Strategic planning

1. Utilize the Google Doc Template that can be found [**here**](#) (please make a copy, do not edit the original)

1. Choose one business vertical and create a list of the objectives and tactics to engage and grow within that business vertical

Step 3: Select engagement activities

Your Routes to Market/Territory Plan will help you determine which GitLab resources to use to

gain a point of entry into prospective opportunities. Use the list below with your team to determine the best activities to make contact with an opportunity representative.

- Marketing
 - What external events attract my customers?
 - What internal events might apply?
 - External:
 - Trade Shows
 - Internal (Growth or Land and Expand):
 - Lunch and Learns
 - Workshops
 - Networking
 - Meetups
 - Marketing Campaigns
- Division Programs
 - Are there specific company initiatives that might provide an entry point?
 - The goal is to pick off individual programs within company divisions to build momentum towards capturing your market
- Cloud Provider Partnerships
 - Are they using the Cloud? - Which ones?
 - Partner with those that your customer uses as a way to leverage an entry point.
 - Work with our Channel Team to get to the right contacts with the right value proposition
 - You have to sell the Cloud provider on what's in it for them:
 - GitLab accelerates Cloud Adoption - drives usage growth
- System Integrator (SI) Partnerships
 - Do they do their own IT support or hire it out? - Which ones?
 - Work with the Channel Team to get to the right contacts.
 - Use this as a way to "create an internal champion"
 - If they are currently not a GitLab partner, make them one
 - Sell them on "thought leadership, speed to delivery, revenue stream."
- Resellers
 - Do they buy direct or through resellers? - Which ones?
 - Work with the Channel Team to get to the right contacts.
 - Use this as a way to "be a force multiplier" (there is only one of you)
 - If they are currently not a GitLab partner, make them one
 - They typically rep a lot of products, so make it easy for them to give the GitLab Story
 - Give them your latest briefing deck, walk them through the talking points.
 - Sell them on "thought leadership, speed to delivery, revenue stream."
- Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEM)
 - Are there other software technologies they currently use that might integrate with GitLab to provide an entry point?
 - Work with the OEM Team or the customer to get to the right contacts.
 - You will have to sell them on the benefits of working with us.
 - "thought leadership, speed to delivery, revenue stream."
 - This can be both an entry point but also a growth strategy.
- Industry Memberships
 - Do the executive and management staff belong to any industry groups? - Which ones?
 - Not just the obvious ones (Tech or DevOps) but their own industry Groups (Healthcare, Manufacturing, Transportation, Financial, etc.)
 - Meet with our Marketing Team for advice

- Use this as a way to gain credibility and for networking.

Step 4. Meeting preparation and execution

At this point, the selected engagement activities should have generated a significant number of leads. It's now time to sift through those leads and determine which may become opportunities. This requires an initial qualifying meeting and the quality the preparation you take for that meeting can mean the difference in having a deal or losing a deal. The steps that necessary to prepare and execute a successful meeting are:

1. **Determine your Buyer Persona** - a buyer persona is a fictional representation of your key buyers. This helps you pre-identify obstacles, objections, initiatives, and metrics that are important to your buyer. This step will give you an edge in understanding your customers better than your competition. There are typically 5 buyer personas you may encounter.

- Technology Leader
- Business Application Leader
- Security Leaders
- COO/CXO Leader
- Financial Leader

1. **Reference Buyer Process Maps (BPMs)** - are maps of mental pathways buyers' travel to make decisions. BPMs will guide selling activity based on where the buyer is in their process. Your goals in this step is differentiation, reduction in resistance, avoid wasting cycles, and facilitate better meetings and create Moments that Matter. See a breakdown of the **Buyer Process Map** stage and the common buyer actions that indicate what stages of the buyer process the prospect is in.

1. **Research the Buyer** - includes a number of sub-tasks necessary to get additional insight into the buyer.

1. **Reference SFDC** to see if the lead is a current customer or prospect. Review their digital body language such as recent activities and past contact.

1. **Reference LinkedIn** and cross reference the contact's profile to relevant buyer personas and look for overlaps.

1. **Reference the company's website** and absorb basics related to strategic goals, industry, business model, their buyer, etc.

1. **Develop Pre-Call Planning Questions** to better determine what discovery questions. The pre-call planning questions will cause you as the seller to further validate and reference the buyer persona you will engage with.

1. **Develop a Persona Based Call Plan** to ensure that you gather more pertinent information from the buyer. It will help identify information gaps, set specific objectives, and ultimately increase your buyer's confidence in you.

1. **Utilize MEDDPIC** to create Discovery questions to gather the information necessary to qualify the opportunity. MEDDPIC is a qualification framework that will help you determine if the opportunity is worth your time, effort, and company resources. It will help you to more quickly determine what stage the buyer falls in the sales process. The framework will also expose problems and clarify next steps. It will help make you more efficient and focused sales representatives by making it easier to sort the good deals from no deals, and quick deals from long term deals. The foundation of MEDDPIC is based on asking good discovery questions.

1. **Ask effective, open-ended Discovery Questions** to identify existing customer needs, problems, pain points, goals etc. The GitLab CxO Digital Transformation Discovery Guide is a helpful resource with sample discovery questions for senior economic buyers.

1. **Prepare a Meeting Agenda** to identify how the buyer wants will match what you will cover.

Leverage this Pre-Call Plan document to prepare for this and subsequent customer calls/meetings. In addition, consider sending your proposed agenda to the buyer in advance of the meeting to ensure alignment. For each agenda item, include some questions from the BPM, prepare statements, industry case studies. Research 1-3 items in the Objectives and Obstacles section of the personas. Finalize your meeting objectives in order to show the buyer you are prepared, listening, and empathic. Structure the meeting so that the prospect is relaxed and is comfortable going deep with their problems and needs.

1. Utilize a Command Plan to track the progress of a deal. The Command Plan an iterative document within Salesforce that gives you and your team macro and micro level visibility into an opportunity. It is designed to align and guide you through the necessary MEDDPICCC process to quickly capture the information necessary to properly qualify an opportunity. Here is a sample Command Plan.

Reminder: A Command Plan is not a one and done document. Nor will you gather all the necessary information in one meeting, so be prepared to work through pieces of the document over a series of meetings. Taking this time up front will help you better evaluate the deal by asking deeper trap-setting questions that will help you gather more insightful data about your customer.

As a rule of thumb, here is the cadence for updating your Command Plans.

- Command Plan: Opportunity Overview - Real Time
- Command Plan: MEDDPICCC Data - Real Time
- Command Plan: Close Plan - Real Time

Step 5. Qualify the opportunity

Once you have conducted the initial qualifying meeting. You and your team should review all the data gathered in the Command Plan. This includes a review of the research conducted, the discovery questions asked, how much MEDDPICCC data was captured in the Command Plan, and what gaps you still have outstanding to capture. Depending on the level of data captured, the lead can then be evaluated according to the below listed criteria to recategorize from a lead to a Sales Accepted Opportunity:

- Authority (Is the prospect a person with decision- making authority?)
 - The prospect being met is directly involved in a project or team related to the potential purchase of GitLab within this buying group, either as an evaluator, decision maker, technical buyer, or influencer.
- Initiative (Is it a Small Box sale or is this a Top 2 priority?)
 - A Small Box opportunity is one where the buyer buys the smallest solution necessary that will solve the very specific problem they know they need to solve immediately. (This criteria is specific to Commercial Sales)
 - A Top 2 Priority is an initiative the company is working on has been identified and GitLab can potentially help the initiative. Identified by either a business problem (i.e too many tools), strategic direction or modernization interest (impetus to change).
- Fit (How well does the lead align with the GitLab product?)
 - Current DevOps or software development lifecycle tools (from conversation or credible data source)
 - Expected entry point use case (e.g. SCM or CI)
 - Potential seats of the first opportunity (if this is a new account or buying group)
- Timing (How Soon Will They Buy?)

- After the initial qualifying meeting with the account leader/executive, there must be a next step that is set to occur within a 60 day timeframe. (If next step isn't within a 60 day timeframe, the opportunity remains in stage 0).

Once the lead has been evaluated according to the above criteria, it can be designated as a qualified opportunity. An OPPORTUNITY can be created in Salesforce a) when converting a LEAD to CONTACT; b) from a CONTACT. All opportunities should be created with a Stage = 0-Pending Acceptance regardless of how you create the OPPORTUNITY. Once the initial setup is complete, the OPPORTUNITY Stage can be updated within Salesforce.

Step 6. Pipeline management and forecasting

Your goal is to close deals and the best way to do that is to track where your sales stands within your sales framework as well as where the deal stands within the buyer's journey. This is done through pipeline management and forecasting.

Pipeline Management

Pipeline Management is typically done in Salesforce, and forecasting is done in Clari. The common pipeline stages within Salesforce are the following:

- 0 - Pending Acceptance
- 1 - Discovery
- 2 - Scoping
- 3 - Technical Evaluation
- 4 - Proposal
- 5 - Negotiating
- 6 - Awaiting Signature
- 7 - Closed Won
- 8 - Lost

Below are DAILY TASKS you'll need to perform within Salesforce.

1. Accurately document each stage of the sales cycle using the list above. This requires you to assess each opportunity based on what tasks have taken place. If you have gathered data and the deal meets the criteria in step 5, the deal can then be designated as 0 - Pending Acceptance.

- When you have scheduled a follow up meeting to interview and obtain in depth MEDDPIC data the opportunity should be designated as stage 1 - Discovery.

- Pipeline Hygiene: Generally review your accounts DAILY, but depending on the size of your book of business, it should be at least once per week.

- Identify prospects who have been in your sales pipeline longer than your average sales cycle.

- Before you completely give up on a prospect, send them a sales breakup email

1. Use a repeatable framework for pipeline management is:

1. Connect via email, phone, or zoom meeting.

1. Use discovery questions to assess the buyer's interest level using the Buyer's Process Map

1. Document the interaction in Salesforce

1. Set Appointment if possible

1. Send followup documentation to further educate the customer

1. Keep your pipeline leads high by flowing using a standard followup process
 1. Conduct engagement activities on a Regular Basis as outlined in Step 3: Select Engagment Activities.
 1. Set a response time to respond to inbound leads
 1. Set a number of touches per lead spread out over one month
 1. Set a number and a variety of email, phone, and social media touches a lead receives
 1. Every touch a lead receives should include new information or resources from the Use Case GTM Bill of Material Priorities matrix.

Forecasting

Forecasting in simple terms is determining if you will hit your sales numbers at a given point in time. Clari is the tool to help you track your sales projections. Clari delivers insights by pulling data from all your engagements (phone calls, emails, calendar, social media, and news) and fuses that data so that you can better estimate the timing and likelihood of closing. Clari is also a good tool to quickly understand your sales gap to quota and help you focus on your deals from best case to worst case.

Below are the WEEKLY TASK you'll need to perform within Clari. Navigate to the Net ARR tab within Clari.

1. Renewal Loss Best Case
 - Click "Net ARR", then Click "Renewal Loss Best Case". This field should reflect the value of non-renewals during the current quarter with a LOWER probability (or Best Case) but a HIGHER value than Renewal Loss Commit.
1. Renewal Loss Commit
 - Click "Net ARR", then Click "Renewal Loss Commit". This field should reflect the value of non-renewals during the current quarter with a HIGHER probability (or Commit) but a LOWER value than Renewal Loss Best Case.
1. Gross ARR Best Case
 - Click "NetIACV", then Click "Gross ARR BEST CASE ". This field should have the value for your Gross ARR Best Case minus your Renewal Loss Best Case.
1. Gross ARR COMMIT
 - Click "Net ARR", then Click "Gross ARR Commit". This field should have the value for your Gross ARR Commit minus your Renewal Loss Commit.
1. NET 50/50
 - Click "Net ARR", then Click "Net 50/50". This field should have the value for what you believe will be the actual forecast for your team. If you consider the Commit as the floor and Best Case as the ceiling, then the 50-50 is what is the most likely outcome.

For in-depth training on Clari go to the Clari for Salespeople Instructional Videos.

Now you are ready to move into the next phase of the sales cycle, Facilitating the Opportunity.

SECTION: sales/sales-term-glossary/_index.md

Customer Definitions for External Reporting

Please see the Sales Term Glossary Doc

SECTION: sales/sales-term-glossary/arr-in-practice.md

The below page includes a deep-dive into the definition of ARR at GitLab and is a sub-page of the Sales Term Glossary Page.

Annual Recurring Revenue (ARR)

Please see the Sales Handbook Definitions Doc

SECTION: sales/territories/_index.md

Please see the Sales Handbook Definitions Document

SECTION: sales/territories/latam.md

Please see the Internal Sales Definitions Document

SECTION: sales/territories/territory-deprecate.md

Please see the Internal Sales Definitions Document

SECTION: sales/training/_index.md

GitLab Sales Learning Framework

GitLab field team members are expected to be knowledgeable and proficient across a variety of topics, skills, behaviors, and processes. For ease of consumption, sales training resources are organized in 6 categories below. If you are looking for more immediate access to resources to support your selling efforts, please check out the Sales Resources page.

For the latest Field Enablement Spotlight videos and training resources please see the Field Enablement Spotlight: Continuous Education at GitLab page on Highspot.

GitLab Target Audiences

Successful field team members must have an intimate understanding of ideal customer profiles, customer environments where opportunities for GitLab are most ripe, targeted buyer personas, industry-relevant insights, and more.

| Topic | Resource(s) |

| ----- | ----- |

| What is GitLab's ideal customer profile? | - Handbook page
- GitLab Account Based Marketing and Ideal Customer Profile (Mar 2020, 34 minutes) (internal only) |

| What business problems does GitLab help customers solve? | - Check out the value drivers and other materials on the GitLab Command of the Message page |

| What are target buyer personas and their pain points? | - GitLab Buyer Personas
 - Interview with an IT Agility Director
 - Learn more about Enterprise IT roles & key pain points |

| What are target user personas and their pain points? | - Handbook page |

Industry Topics & Trends

To serve as trusted advisors to customers and partners, GitLab field team members must be able to competently and confidently engage with customers on topics like the Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC), Source Code Management (SCM) / Version Control & Collaboration, open source & open core, DevOps, Continuous Integration & Continuous Delivery (CI/CD), containers, Kubernetes, and more.

| Topic | Resource(s) |

| ----- | ----- |

| What is DevOps? | - DevOps Explained (20 minutes)
 - Video (Dec 2013, 7 minutes)
 - Stages of the DevOps Lifecycle
 - DevOps terms: 10 essential concepts, explained |

| What is the software development life cycle and how is software developed and deployed? | - GitLab's public website on the SDLC
 - What is the Software Development Lifecycle (SDLC)? (July 2018, 11 minutes)
 - Software Development Lifecycle (SDLC) in 9 minutes! (Jan 2016, 9 minutes)
 - How is software made using GitLab? (Nov 2019, 23 minutes)|

| What is Git? | - Git Tutorials |

| What is cloud-native? | - GitLab website
 - Video on Cloud-Native Transformation (Mar 2019, 29 minutes) |

| What is SCM? | - Video (June 2019, 29 minutes) |

| What is CI and CD? | - GitLab Continuous Integration (CI) & Continuous Delivery (CD)
 - Modernize Your CI/CD eBook
 - Click here to enroll in the Continuous Integration learning path (Aug 2020) |

| What is DevSecOps?
 What is "shift left?" | - Security & Governance Enablement Update (Oct 2022, 30 minutes)
 - DevSecOps Campaign Refresh (Oct 2021, 30 minutes)
 - DevSecOps with GitLab
 - 2019 Global Developer Report: DevSecOps
 - Speed up secure software delivery with DevSecOps (Apr 2019)
 - Click here to enroll in the DevSecOps learning path. (Aug 2020) |

| What is Auto DevOps? | - Auto DevOps |

| What is GitOps and Infrastructure as Code? | - Why GitOps should be the workflow of choice (Apr 2020)
 - Optimize GitOps workflow with version control from GitLab (Oct 2019) |

| What is open source? | - Check out this post on opensource.com |

| What is open core? | - What to consider with an open source business model (Jul 2019) |

| What are microservices? | - Video: What are microservices? (Jan 2019, 19 minutes)
 - What are microservices? |

| What is serverless? | - What is Serverless? (Jan 2019, 18 minutes) |

| What are containers? | - What are containers and why do you need them? (Jun 2017)
 - What are containers? (Mar 2018, 9 minutes) |

| What is Kubernetes? | - What is Kubernetes? (Jun 2018, 12 minutes)
 - The Evolution of

the Kubernetes Landscape (Nov 2019, 30 minutes)
 - First Steps to Becoming Certified Kubernetes App Developer (30-60 minutes)
 - Kubernetes API Fundamentals (30 minutes) |
What is complete DevOps?	- The entire DevOps lifecycle in one application
What is concurrent DevOps?	- Video (Apr 2019, 24.5 minutes) - GitLab Concurrent DevOps white paper (internal link) (gated link)
How do I keep up to date with industry trends?	- Review and subscribe to the following blogs: Hacker News, Martin Fowler, and New Stack

Why GitLab?

GitLab field team members must be able to clearly articulate a compelling, differentiated, value-driven message to customers, prospects, and partners.

| Topic | Resource(s) |

| ----- | ----- |

What is GitLab?	- GitLab Explainer Video (Oct 2020, 1.5 minutes) - GitLab infomercial featuring David Astor (Feb 2020, 5.5 minutes)
GitLab is THE DevOps Platform	- The DevOps Platform customer deck (Enterprise) (internal only) - The DevOps Platform Customer Deck e-learning course (30 minutes) - DevOps Platform Message House
Key value drivers and differentiators	- Review the Command of the Message page - Operational Efficiencies (May 2020, 32 minutes) - End to End Visibility & Insights (Apr 2020, 31 minutes) - Understand the 3 types of differentiators: Unique, Comparative, and Holistic
Positioning GitLab	- FY24-Q2 Revenue Play: GitLab AI (May 2023, 30 minutes) - Winning with Value Stream Assessments (Mar 2023, 30 minutes) - FY24-Q1 Revenue Play - Achieving Efficiencies via Toolchain Consolidation (Mar 2023, 25 minutes) - FY23-Q4 Product Spotlight: Winning with Ultimate (Dec 2022, 30 minutes) - Strategic Selling & ROI (Nov 2022, 30 minutes) - Solution Selling (Mar 2022, 25 minutes) - GitLab customer deck (presentation) - GitLab customer deck video (Dec 2019, 28 minutes) - GitLab Sales Kickoff 2020: Articulating and Selling the GitLab Vision & Customer Journey (slides) (video) (Feb 2020, 37.5 minutes) - GitLab value prop messaging - Pitch deck - Delivering the GitLab pitch deck (Apr 2019, 14 minutes) - Removing Software Bottlenecks (Mar 2019, 30 minutes) - Forrester Total Economic Impact Report (July 2020, 60 minutes) - Demystifying the Metrics Conversation (Aug 2020, 30 minutes)
What customer ROI models are available?	- Forrester TEI Enablement (Study + Estimator) (Dec 2022, 30 minutes) - The New Simple ROI Calculator (July 2022, 24 minutes) - Check out the resources on this page
GitLab culture	- GitLab Culture - GitLab Values - This is GitLab video (Feb 2018, 3.5 minutes) - Everyone Can Contribute video (May 2019, 3.5 minutes)
GitLab subscription model	- How GitLab.com Subscriptions Work (Jun 2019, 29 minutes)
GitLab vision	- Review GitLab's Direction
Follow GitLab	- Review and subscribe to the GitLab blog

Competition

To maximize opportunities, GitLab field team members must demonstrate the knowledge and ability to beat out various competitors.

| Topic | Resource(s) |

| ----- | ----- |
 | Who are GitLab's competitors? | - GitLab Comparison Page |
 | What is Competitive Intelligence? | - Check out the Handbook page |
 | Microsoft Azure DevOps | - Competing against Microsoft for Plan - Azure Boards (Jun 2021, 30 minutes)
- Q2 FY22 Microsoft Competitive Update (Jun 2021, 30 minutes)
 - Q3 FY21 Microsoft Competitive Update (Sep 2020, 27 minutes)
 - Proactively Competing Against Microsoft presentation (SKO 2020, internal only)
 - Proactively Competing Against Microsoft private video (Feb 2020, 58 minutes) |
 | GitHub | - Winning Against Github (Jan 2023, 30 Minutes)
 - GitHub Tiers & Support (May 2020, 30 Minutes)
 - GitHub Competitive Update (Apr 2020, 26 minutes) |
 | Jenkins | - Proactively Competing Against Jenkins presentation (SKO 2020, internal only)
 - Competing Against Jenkins and CloudBees (Sep 2019, 25 minutes)
 - Jenkins: Competitive Overview (Feb 2019, 31 minutes)
 - Jenkins: Overcoming Objections (Mar 2019, 26 minutes)
 - GitLab vs Jenkins, where is GitLab weaker? (Feb 2019, 25.5 minutes) |
 | Where may one find additional competitive insights? | - How GitLab Competes with Snyk (Oct 2022, 30 minutes)
 - Q1 FY22 Competitive Update (Feb 2021, 30 minutes)
 - GitLab's Competitive Intelligence Resources Page is the single source of truth for competitive sales resources organized by competitor
 - Compete page overview and launch to sales (June 2020, 27 minutes) |

GitLab Portfolio

GitLab field team members must understand how various elements of the GitLab portfolio (offering tiers, SDLC phases, services, training, etc.) solve customer challenges.

Topic	Resource(s)
What is GitLab's product strategy?	- GitLab Dedicated (Jun 2023, 30 minutes) - Automated Software Delivery (AutoSD) Integrated Campaign (Aug 2022, 21 minutes) - Positioning & Selling GitLab.com (June 2022, 26 minutes) - 15.0 Release (May 2022, 18 minutes) - GitLab acquires Opstrace (Dec 2021, 20 minutes) - Breaking Changes in 14.0 - AMA with Product & Customer Success (Jun 2021, 30 minutes) - Positioning Verify & Product Vision (Mar 2021, 30 minutes) - GitLab Direction - Advantages of a single application - GitLab Sales Kickoff 2021 Product Keynote: A Winning Product for Peak Performance (slides) (video) (Feb 2021, 88 minutes)
What are GitLab's product tiers?	- GitLab Tiers - Why GitLab Ultimate? - Why GitLab Premium? - Feature comparison - The Journey to Ultimate (Nov 2021, 48 minutes) - How to upgrade your customer to a higher tier (Jul 2019, 26 minutes) - Discovery Questions for Selling GitLab Ultimate and GitLab Premium - Seven Ways GitLab Premium will Accelerate Customer Development (July 2020, 40 minutes)
How is GitLab priced?	- Pricing page - Pricing model in the Handbook
What are the GitLab customer use cases (solutions)?	- Check out the Customer Use Cases Handbook page - Use Case Driven Go To Market (GTM)
Where may I learn about the Version Control & Collaboration use case / solution (formerly Source Code Management (SCM))?	- Check out the Version Control & Collaboration Handbook page - The GitLab Journey & The SCM Use Case (Mar 2020, 27 minutes)
Where may I learn about the Continuous Integration (CI) customer use case / solution?	- Check out the Continuous Integration (CI) Handbook page - The GitLab Journey & The CI Use Case (Mar 2020, 30 minutes) - Forrester Wave Cloud CI Report: What It Means to GitLab Sales, Customers & Prospects (Oct 2019, 32 minutes) - Complete the Continuous Integration

Customer Use Case learning path in Level Up (internal only).
 - Just want to take the knowledge check quiz? Click Here |

| Where may I learn about the DevSecOps customer use case / solution (aka Shift Left Security)? | - Check out the DevSecOps Handbook page
 - Complete the DevSecOps Customer Use Case learning path in Level Up (internal only)
 - Just want to take the knowledge check quiz? Click Here |

| Where may I learn about the DevOps Platform customer use case / solution? | - Check out the DevOps Platform Handbook page
 - GitLab AutoDevOps Run Click-Through Demo (Apr 2019, 21 minutes)
 - Complete the DevOps Platform Customer Use Case learning path in Level Up (internal only). |

| Where may I learn about the GitOps customer use case / solution? | - Check out the GitOps Handbook page
 - Watch The GitLab Journey & the GitOps Use Case (July 2020, 30 minutes) |

| Where may I learn about the Agile Planning customer use case / solution? | - Check out the Agile Planning website page (Handbook page coming soon)
 - Agile Project & Portfolio Management on GitLab Click-Through Demo (Jun 2019, 30 minutes) |

| Are additional customer use cases / solutions being considered and/or developed? | - Yes, check out the Customer Use Cases Handbook page for the latest and greatest information |

| What about services? | - Positioning Professional Services (Apr 2023, 29 minutes)
 - Professional services, available through GitLab or partners, help to optimize your organization's adoption of GitLab, continue to leverage the tools your teams use every day, facilitate your transition to GitLab, and deliver hands-on training to accelerate your team's adoption
 - Q1 FY23 Professional Services Update (Mar 2022, 25 minutes)
 - GitLab Value Stream Assessments (Feb 2022, 29 minutes)
 - Services to Accelerate Customer Adoption
 - How to engage Professional Services to help you sell and scope
 - Professional Services Full Catalog
 - The Value of Professional Services: A CFOs Perspective (Aug 2020, 29 minutes)
 - Professional Services Offerings & Positioning (Apr 2020, 29 minutes)
 - Selling Services to Accelerate Customer Adoption (Oct 2019, 28 minutes) |

| What about GitLab security? | - Solution Selling: Compliance (Apr 2022, 29 minutes)
 - Product Stage Direction - Secure
 - From SCM and CI to Security: Paths to Ultimate (slides from GitLab Sales Kickoff 2020)
 - How GitLab Helps Customers Achieve Compliance (May 2020, 26 minutes)
 - Forrester Software Composition Analysis (SCA) Wave & Security Q&A (Apr 2019, 30 minutes)
- GitLab SOC2 Security Compliance |

| What about GitLab testing capabilities? | - Pipeline Security Direction Handbook pages
 - Verify: Pipeline Security Category Vision and Positioning (Sep 2021, 26 minutes) |

| What are the most common technical questions that GitLab sales team members should be able to answer? | - Check out the Technical Questions for Sales page |

| Where can I learn about GitLab High Availability, Data Resiliency and Performance? | - Check out the Operational Efficiencies & Flexible Hosting Options with Gitaly Cluster video. (Dec 2021, 30 minutes) |

| Where can I learn about GitLab Cloud Licensing? | - Check out the GitLab Cloud Licensing Update video. (Mar 2022, 30 minutes) |

Functional and Technical Skills & Processes

To optimize productivity, GitLab field team members must be able to consistently demonstrate the skills and behaviors (including adherence to standard processes and use of tools like Salesforce, Gainsight, and others) that lead to desired outcomes. These functional and technical skills and processes are complementary and in addition to GitLab's Values and Remote Working competencies.

Topic	Resource(s)

| GitLab Sales Plays | - FY23-Q3 Revenue Play: Winning with Ultimate (Aug 2022, 17 minutes)

- Sales Play: GitLab Runner & CI (Feb 2022, 30 minutes)
- Sales Play: Infrastructure Automation with GitOps (May 2021, 30 minutes)
- GitLab Premium to GitLab Ultimate Sales Playbook Launch (Apr 2021, 25 minutes)|

| Qualification Best Practices | - Figuring out if you truly have an opportunity (Dec 2020, 25 minutes)|

| What are the critical skills and behaviors needed to succeed in a field role at GitLab? | - Field Functional Competencies |

| What is social selling? | - Social Selling Handbook page
- Social Selling Basics presentation |

| How do I find out what version of GitLab my customers are using?
 How do I find organizations in my patch using GitLab CE? | - Version.GitLab.Com Walk-Through (Jul 2019, 8.5 minutes) |

| What does a good discovery call look like? | - Anatomy of a Successful Discovery Call (Jul 2019, 21 minutes) |

| How do I lead with insights? | - Working with Analyst Relations (Jan 2023, 30 minutes)
- Pipeline Creation - Leading with Insights (Nov 2019, 10 minutes) |

| How can I successfully engage with Channel / Alliance Partners? | - FY24-Q1 Channel Program Update (Apr 2023, 30 minutes)
- Co-Selling with Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (Mar 2023, 20 minutes)
- CDW & Arctiq - Partner Solution Showcase (Feb 2023, 21 minutes)
- VMWare Partnership and Go-to-Market Approaches (Sep 2022, 31 minutes)
- Q3 FY23 Channel Update (Aug 2022, 30 minutes)
- Alliance Technology Partner Solutions (June 2022, 24 minutes)
- Q1 FY23 Channel Update (February 2022, 30 minutes)
- GitLab on IBM Power - Modernization (January 2022, 30 minutes)
- GitLab & Service Now: Better Together (August 2021, 30 minutes)
- Q3 FY22 Channel Update: Overview of Partner Program & Sales Systems Changes (August 2021, 30 minutes)
- Q2 FY22 Alliances Update: The Importance of Ecosystem Partners (July 2021, 12 minutes)
- Q2 FY22 Channel Program Update (May 2021, 30 minutes)
- Co-selling with AWS (Apr 2021, 30 minutes)
- Co-selling with GCP (Mar 2021, 30 minutes)
- GitLab & IBM - Better Together (Mar 2021, 30 minutes)
- The GitLab / RedHat Partnership (Jan 2021, 30 minutes)
- Deal Registration Program and Working with Partners (Dec 2020, 30 minutes)
- Maximizing Value of Partners in a Deal (Nov 2020, 30 minutes)
- Channel Partner Success for GitLab Sellers (Jul 2020, 30 minutes) |

| How can I accelerate my pipeline with AWS? | - AWS Alliances: New AWS Marketplace listing and upcoming Credit Promotion (May 2022, 33 minutes)
- Best Practices for Co-Selling with AWS (Feb 2022, 25 minutes)
- Accelerating Your Pipeline with AWS for GitLab Sellers (Sep 2020, 30 minutes) |

| How do I create a quote using Zuroa CPQ? | - FY24-Q1 Sales Ops Update - Quote Studio (Feb 2023, 28 minutes)
- Take the Quote Studio eLearning course on Level Up here. |

| What is DocuSign and how do I use it? | - Q2 FY22 Docusign Rollout (May 2021, 18 minutes) |

| How do I forecast at GitLab? | - Sales Forecasting at GitLab |

| What is Chorus.ai and how do I use it? | - Chorus Native Zoom Recent Changes
- Zoom Desktop client vs. Browser client when using Chorus
- Chorus FAQs: Stop & Start a Recording
- Chorus.ai is a leading conversation intelligence platform
- How to find a call in Chorus (Jul 2019, 4 minutes)
- How to review a call in Chorus (Jul 2019, 7 minutes)
- How to comment and share moments in Chorus (Jul 2019, 5 minutes)
- How to gain compliance on recorded calls (primarily for NA) (Jul 2019, 6 minutes) |

| Where do I learn about quarterly co-terms? | - Quarterly Co-Terms May 2020 Update (May 2020, 27 minutes) |

How do I find customer references?	- Q1 FY23 Customer References Update (Mar 2022, 17 minutes) - Reference Edge - Customer Reference Process video (Jan 2020, 25 minutes)
Presentation skills	- How to Avoid Death by PowerPoint (20 minutes)
How should I work with the GitLab Legal team?	- Basics of Legal Subscription Agreements (Sep 2022, 27 minutes) - Sales Guide: Collaborating with GitLab Legal
What are sales negotiation and closing best practices at GitLab?	- Co-Selling Executive Business Reviews (September 2021, 30 minutes) - Negotiate to Close Handbook page - Closing Best Practices (27 minutes, July 2020) - Deal Structure Best Practices (28 minutes, October 2020)
Proof of Value for SAs	- Proof of Value Review
Customer Onboarding for Customer Success Managers (CSMs)	- Customer Onboarding Custom Object Video (Nov 2019, 17 minutes) - Customer Onboarding Custom Object Deck - Customer Onboarding Salesforce Dashboard
Gainsight for SAs	- Office Hours for Gainsight & Account Planning (May 2021, 25 minutes) - Gainsight Overview (May 2020, 6.5 minutes) - Gainsight Overview for Sales (Aug 2020, 27 minutes) - Gainsight View Only Licenses (July 2020, 9 minutes)
Gainsight for CSMs	- Using Gainsight within Customer Success Handbook page Success Plans Handbook page - Gainsight Foundations (overview of the Gainsight NXT Platform and a brief demo of key capabilities) (26 minutes) - Gainsight Reports and Dashboards (overview of how to leverage dashboards within the tool to make better decisions on managing your accounts) (19 minutes) - Calls to Action (CTA), Playbooks, and the Cockpit (overview of Calls to Action (CTAs) in the Cockpit, the tool to manage customer outreach, as well as playbooks) (23 minutes) - 360 View, Health Scores, and Timeline (overview of the 360 feature for research and call prep, Timeline for centralized note-taking, and an overview of health scores and trend insights) (34 minutes) - Sally Bot in Slack (overview of what Sally is and how to use it) (15 minutes)
Other	- Things I Wish I Knew During My First Few Quarters at GitLab video (Aug 2019, 25.5 minutes) - Sessions (presentations, videos) from GitLab Sales Kickoff 2021 - Sessions from GitLab Sales Kickoff 2020
Where can I go to learn more?	- Bookmark the GitLab Sales Handbook - Upcoming and past Level Up sales enablement webcasts - Customer Success Skills Exchange GitLab Unfiltered playlist on YouTube - Check out past Customer Success meetings where new features from recent product releases are discussed and/or demo'ed

Field Enablement Spotlight Sessions

Live sales enablement sessions are held every Thursday from 12:00-12:30pm ET with the exception of the last two weeks of every quarter. Sessions are recorded and published to Highspot, made available for on-demand playback, and added to the inventory above. [Learn more here.](#)

Customer Success Skills Exchange

Live customer success enablement videocasts are held roughly every other Wednesday. Learn more by visiting the [Customer Success Skills Exchange Sessions Handbook page](#) and/or check out the [Customer Success Skills Exchange playlist on GitLab Unfiltered](#) to watch past sessions at a location and time of your choosing.

Additional Notes

- [Learn about GitLab customer training on the GitLab Training Tracks site](#)

- Learn about the weekly GitLab Field Enablement Spotlight series
- Learn about the weekly GitLab SDR Enablement webcast series

SECTION: sales/training/additional-resources.md

Customer Success (CST) Courses

Explainer Videos

- CST201 GitHub.com vs. GitLab
- CST202 Hosting GitLab in the Cloud
- CST203 Integrating Atlassian and GitLab
- CST204 GitLab Maintenance and Support
- CST205 We already use JIRA, so shouldn't we go with Bitbucket?
- CST206 Traditional DevOps Dasiy Chain

Best Practices on Customer/Prospect Framework

1. Basic Principles to follow in any meeting
2. Preparing for your meeting
3. Types of External Meetings at GitLab
 - Discovery Meeting
 - Technical Meeting
 - Close Plan Meeting
4. After the meeting: Personal Development Plan and Next Steps

Basic Principles to follow in any meeting

See External Communication guidelines.

Preparing for your meeting

In order to have the best meeting, preparation prior to the meeting is key. The following action items are ways to prep for a customer meeting:

Look over notes of previous engagement and keep handy for customer meeting. Write key items to remember during the meeting - make sure to cover these items throughout the meeting.

Look over your agenda and notes for call.

Do research on the company and person(s) and get an understanding of the current state of affairs at their company.

Look over the basic principles of customer meetings and resources in GitLab handbook and make sure you're ready for the meeting.

Types of External meetings at GitLab

Note: Depending on each use case, there may be more or less meetings involved. It's always best to still implement basic principles in each meeting. It's up to one's own judgement to decide what to cover on each meeting.

1. Discovery meeting

- Purpose: Uncover the needs and goals of the audience.
- How to: Qualification questions
 - Tell me at a high level your role, your team, and what you're currently working on
 - State Objective
 - Why the interest in GitLab?
 - What does your current tool stack look like?
 - Why are you making the change?
 - What does the decision making process look like for this evaluation?
 - Budget allocation
 - Timeline
 - Next steps

2. Technical Evaluation

- Purpose: Answer the technical questions that was presented in the previous conversation. Depending on the circumstances of the situation, a Solutions Architect may be present.
- How to:
During discovery meetings, technical questions may pop up that need to be written down and taken to SA's to answer. The goal of this call is to answer the prospect's technical questions and either have a SA on the call or answer the questions yourself. If they need more information, recorded demos and or trials can be leveraged at this point.

3. Close Plan meeting

- Purpose: Wrap up the pre-sales cycle and negotiate contract.
- How to:
This is a short meeting, possibly lasting from 15-20 minutes. This is where you finalize and set up next steps or complete the sales cycle.

After the meeting: Personal Development Plan and Next Steps

For your own benefit, here's a Google form that you can make a copy of and fill out for your own self evaluation after every external meeting. This will help you to track your progress on key practices and to see where you can make improvements.

5 Signs You're Talking At (Not Talking To) Your Prospects

You'd think that for a salesperson, talking a lot about their product would be the best way to win a deal. After all, how can prospects decide to buy (or not) unless they know what they're paying for?

Yet one of sales' biggest ironies is that the more you talk about your product, the less likely you are to actually sell it. While speaking with your prospects is absolutely necessary to close sales, it's all too easy to slip from talking to them into talking at them. The five signs below are easy-to-spot indicators that it's time to let your prospect take center stage.

1. You talk for more than half of each conversation

In general, listening is more valuable to salespeople than talking. It's the best, and in the early stages of a sales conversation, the only way to assess your prospect's business pain, whether they're being truthful, and their level of proficiency in implementing your product.

And listening early on sets the stage for the rest of your sales process. Don't know what your prospect's business strengths and weaknesses are because you never asked? You won't be able to sell to their strengths or bridge the gap in weaker areas.

Can't assess whether your prospect's telling you the truth because you haven't heard them speak enough to understand their voice tone? You won't be able to distinguish between true blockers and brush-off objections.

Haven't fully grasped the root causes of your prospect's business pain? You won't be able to position your product in a way that gets to the heart of a solution.

If you're sensing a trend here, you're right. Not listening enough severely limits your ability to sell successfully. It's like trying to score a goal without knowing which team you play for.

2. You're telling more than asking

But it's not just how much you talk, but also what you say that's important. It's crucial to get your prospect talking as much as possible so you're familiar with their personalities and problems. And this is hard to do if you're not asking questions.

Of course, eventually you'll have to talk more than you ask. Once you get a clear sense of the problem your prospect is trying to solve and their priorities, you'll take the reins. But before that point, err on the side of asking more than you tell.

Dive deep into areas that are important for your prospect and make sure to clarify anything you don't understand. This style lends itself to a slower sales process than showing up with a pitch ready, but you'll set yourself up for success in the long run by building a foundational understanding of your prospect from day one.

3. Your prospect isn't engaging with you

You (hopefully) wouldn't continue to send email after email after email to a prospect who'd never opened or responded to a single message. And that principle applies to conversations as well.

If your prospect's gone quiet, there's a reason. Maybe they're confused. Maybe you started talking about something completely irrelevant to their situation. Maybe you're just not leaving them any opportunity to respond or ask questions.

Make a habit of pausing every few minutes to ask your prospect if they understand or simply give them an opening to speak. Taking your prospect's temperature every so often is invaluable to making sales conversations helpful for them, and ultimately boosts your chances of closing the deal.

4. Your statements could apply to any prospect

Q: Why are conversations about the weather so boring to us?

A: Because they're impersonal and could happen between any two random people.

If you find that you're making generic statements and struggling to resonate, it's because you haven't done enough discovery. Gut check yourself by listening to call recordings or reviewing meetings while they're still fresh in your mind. Did the insights you shared apply specifically to your prospect's situation, or were they overly high-level and universally true?

If it's the latter, dig deeper. While many of your sales conversations will run along the same lines, the nuances and minutia of every situation will vary. If you can't get right to the heart of your prospect's concerns, take a beat to circle back to discovery.

5. You can't define your prospect's problem

Another way to check whether your sales conversations are productive for your prospect is to quiz yourself. Can you explain the deal to someone else on your team?

To test his understanding of a prospect's problems, Dan Tyre, a sales director at HubSpot, tries to define three reasons his prospects would buy, three reasons his prospects would balk, and what the next step should be. If he can't, he knows he needs to get on another call with his prospect to further understand what they want and discuss how to move forward in a mutually productive way.

Ways to influence decision making by using the Psychology of Persuasion

Dr. Robert Cialdini's theory of influence from his book "Influence: The Psychology of Persuasion" defines six principles that guide human behavior. The first principle is reciprocity, the desire to give back to someone who has given to us. E.g. if someone does you a favor you feel obligated to return a favor.

In a sales conversation this principle can be used to influence the direction and outcome of a conversation from the very beginning.

For example if a prospect signs up for a free trial, you can initiate the conversation by offering help with potential issues or questions and making sure the prospect has received the relevant information from the trial confirmation mail, e.g. the license key.

Nearly everyone of us has experienced a situation where a confirmation email didn't arrive or went to the spam folder. So by starting the conversation with a favor, the prospect will feel obligated to take the time to reply and answer your open-ended question.

The principle of reciprocity is also reason why sales emails should always provide value to a customer.

Here are a few examples about how to start a conversation with a prospect who started a trial:

Hi [prospect] and thanks for your interest in GitLab.

In case you didn't see the email from our CustomersDot, I've attached a copy of your trial license key. Let me know if you need help installing or configuring GitLab.

Perhaps let me know what's driving your interest, what